A startup city guide to Korea





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Six places, six strengths



Where	Best for
Gangnam, Seoul	Investors and accelerators
Pangyo	Software, games, enterprise
Seongsu, Seoul	Consumer brands and pop-ups
Busan	Logistics and maritime tech
Daejeon	Research and deep tech
Songdo, Incheon	Biotech, by the airport

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Numbers to know



8th

Seoul in Startup Genome’s 2025 ranking of 300 cities

1st

Seoul’s global rank for knowledge

D-8-4

The technology startup visa for founders

Source: Startup Genome GSER 2025 · 법무부 출입국

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The visa route



D-10-2

Startup preparation visa to get started

OASIS

Training, IP and support earn points

D-8-4

Startup visa, or direct via KSGC top teams

Source: OASIS 글로벌창업이민센터 · KSGC

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Cluster beats capital

In Korea, being close to your industry's cluster matters more than a Seoul postcode.

Games go to Pangyo. Consumer brands go to Seongsu.

Industry

↓

Cluster

↓

Visa support



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Korea's startup map is a set of clusters, not one city.

Taking a Western brand into Japan, Korea or wider APAC?

Give me a shout

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